by hand floats to produce uniform and even surface.

7. **Belting**

Belting is done to finish the surface with a canvas or rubber belt. It is applied cross-wise by two persons and moved longitudinally.

8. **Brooming**

Brooming is done immediately after belting and when concrete is partially set to get rough and gritty surface.

9. **Checking the finished surface**

The road surface is now checked for desired grade and camber and for evenness with a long wooden straight edge during floating. If the tolerance is more than 2mm per metre the portion of the road should be corrected.

10. **Curing**

It is carried out for the concrete to harden. The various curing methods are

a. Use of moist gunny bags
b. Ponding
c. Moist sand or earth covering
d. Use of moist gunny bags for a day and followed by calcium chloride etc.,
e. Steam curing, membrane covering, painting, etc.,

11. **Filling joints and edging**

All the joints are to be filled properly with suitable material.

After completion of concrete slab, brick edging or W.B.M. pavement may be provided to protect the edge of the slab.

Merits Of Concrete Roads

The merits of concrete roads are listed below

1. Low maintenance cost.
2. Concrete roads are dustless, smooth and non-slippery.
3. Can be laid on any subgrade.
4. Can easily be reinforced when required.
5. Do not develop corrugations.
6. Last longer if laid properly.
7. Provide a smooth, safe and excellent surface under all conditions.
8. Have better weather resisting qualities.

Demerits Of Concrete Roads

The demerits of concrete roads are listed below.

1. High initial construction cost.
2. Develop cracks due to temperature variation.
3. Construction requires skilled workmanship and supervision.
4. Require time for curing.
5. Glare due to reflection of sunlight may lead to accidents.
6. Cutting of the slab after laying for any purpose is difficult and costly.

6.6 Soil Stabilization

Stabilization is the process on soil to improve its strength or by reducing its vulnerability to the adverse influences of water and traffic.



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